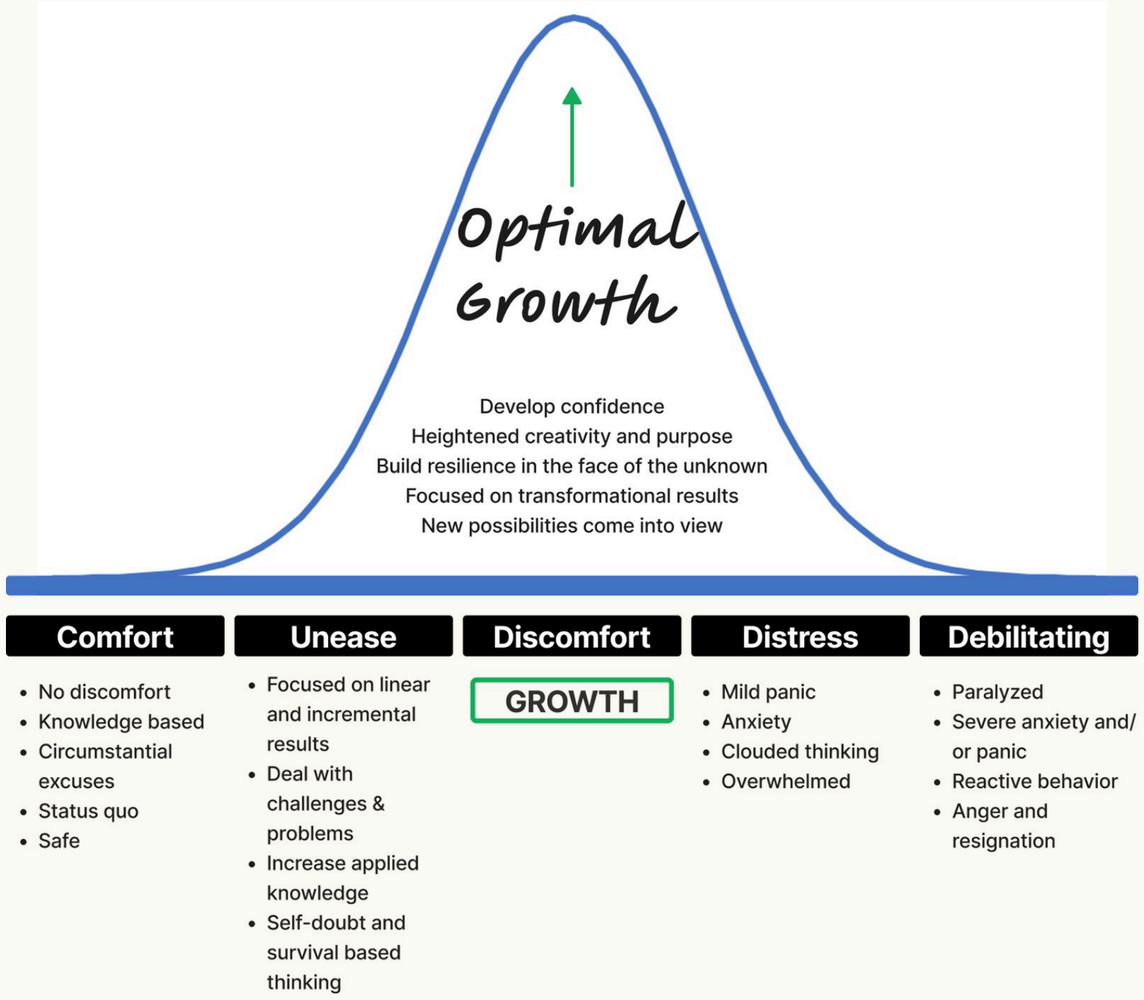
# DMV Digital Services

A vision for our future




# There will be more questions after today, not fewer... and that's ok.

The most important thing is that we lay some groundwork, and we know how we will work together to answer the questions that come up.

# Where we started




A technology team focused on technology projects: predefined outputs, dates and requirements. New kiosks in the field offices, a new look for the website, a new vendor for the renewal form, all delivered on time. We were really, really good at it.

# But then... an idea



A counter clerk, after sending another new-license applicant home without the right documents, asked: "What if we focused more on how people get through this, instead of what we ship?"

# So we embarked on a new journey



**How do we make this change to a more community-focused way of working?**

- One team and one roadmap for the DMV's online services
- New roles: a product manager, a product owner, a UX designer and researcher
- A steering group and an advisory group that meet monthly
- Field office and call center partners who come to sprint reviews

# And now...



We have new team members, some with new focus areas, and a lot of new information coming at us. How do we fit all these pieces together?

# Jot down your questions




We've all had questions about how we are all going to work together. What is the same, what is different. Take 5 minutes to jot down the questions you have. One sticky per question.

# As we go



### Red flags: red stickies

Write down any concern that something might break or go very wrong in the direction I'm presenting.



### Questions: yellow stickies

As I talk you'll have more questions. Write them down as we go.



### Terminology: raise a hand

If a term or concept is unclear, stop me right away.



### Space for grace

I've tried to balance different perspectives and needs, but I'm not perfect. Please give me a little grace.

We'll stop several times to address red flags. Yellow stickies wait until the break.

# This is a long-term vision



This is an ambitious vision for our future. We can't snap our fingers and make it true tomorrow. But we can start now and make steady progress, so we need to know where we're heading.

# Offering a digital service

We need to change how we see and do our work

- From **outputs** to **outcomes**
- From **incremental** to **iterative**
- From **order takers** to **collaborative partners**
- From **requirements** to **feedback**
- From **competing priorities** to **clear direction**
- From **indirectly** to **directly serving the community**

# Outputs to outcomes




The things we release.
The work we completed.

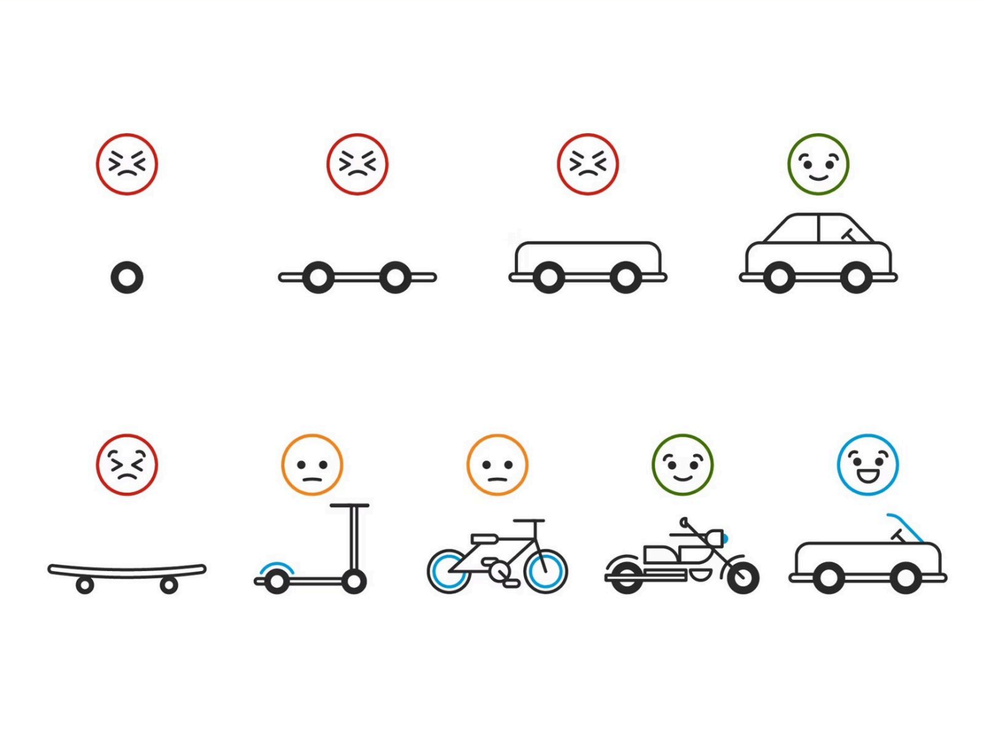
*ex: launched online renewal*




The results we achieve.
The change people experience.

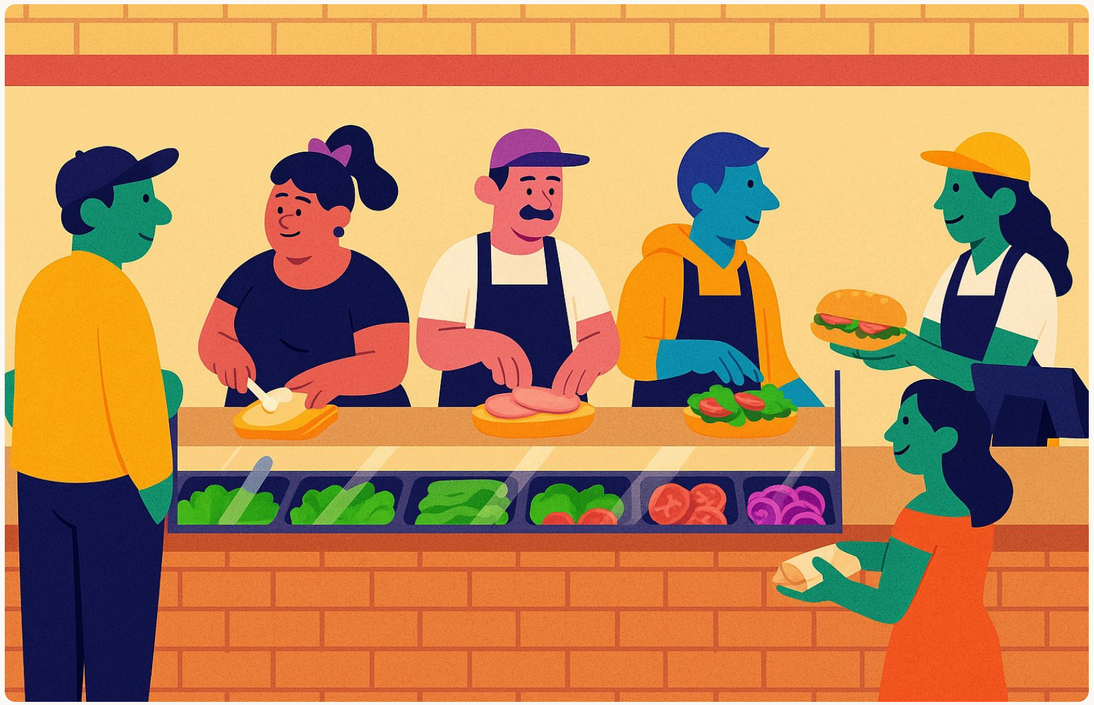
*ex: 75% of renewals done online in under 5 minutes*

# Incremental to iterative



We're used to big projects that take a long time and deliver value at the end. That still fits work with a clear end. For our services, we're shifting to smaller amounts of value, growing as we learn.

# Order takers to collaborative partners



The customer tells us what they want, and we execute.



We're given goals, and we work out how to reach them.

# Requirements to feedback

### Requirements

We write down everything up front and build to the list. We find out if it was right at the end.

### Feedback

We put working things in people's hands early and learn what they actually need.

Some requirements are real: security, compliance, integration. Keep those. The rest are guesses worth testing.

# Competing priorities to clear direction

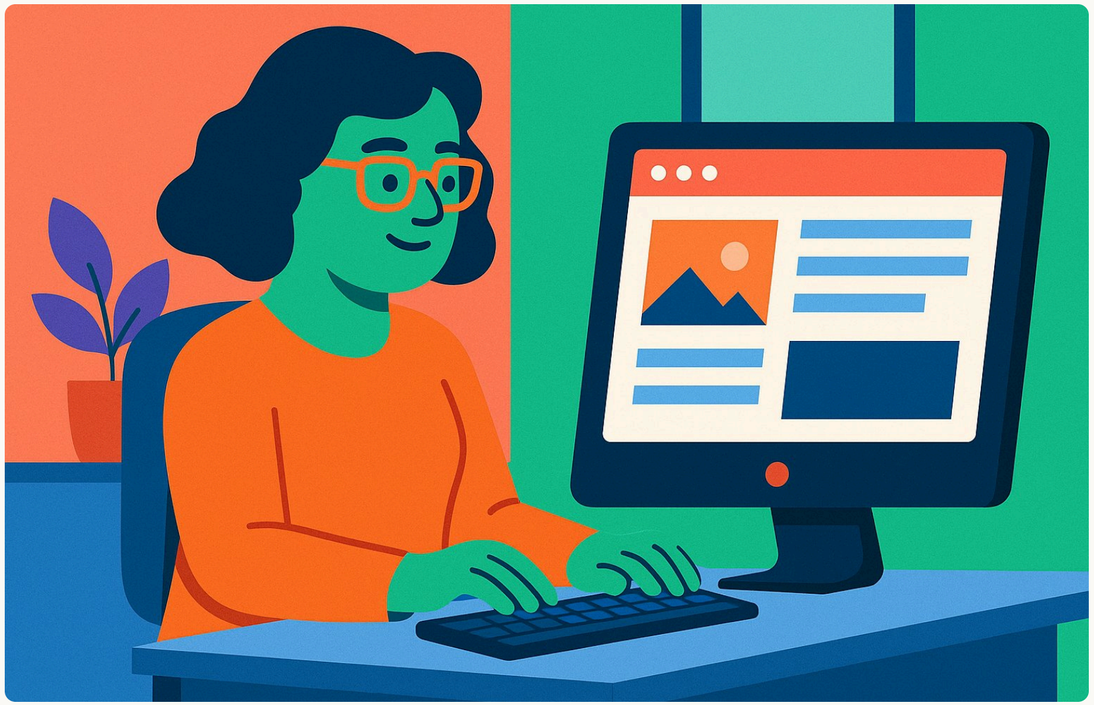



Several people with #1 priorities, each trying to get their work done.



One clear lead, part of the team, directing us toward a vision.

# Indirectly to directly serving the community



Serving the people who serve the people.




Serving the people in partnership with DMV staff.

# Is any of this different?

**90%** the same

**10%** different

Most of what we'll cover won't feel that different. Maybe 10% actually is.




But 10% makes a big difference when you change where you start: the core goals and the point of view.

# Pause for red flags

# One service

One team. One vision. One roadmap.

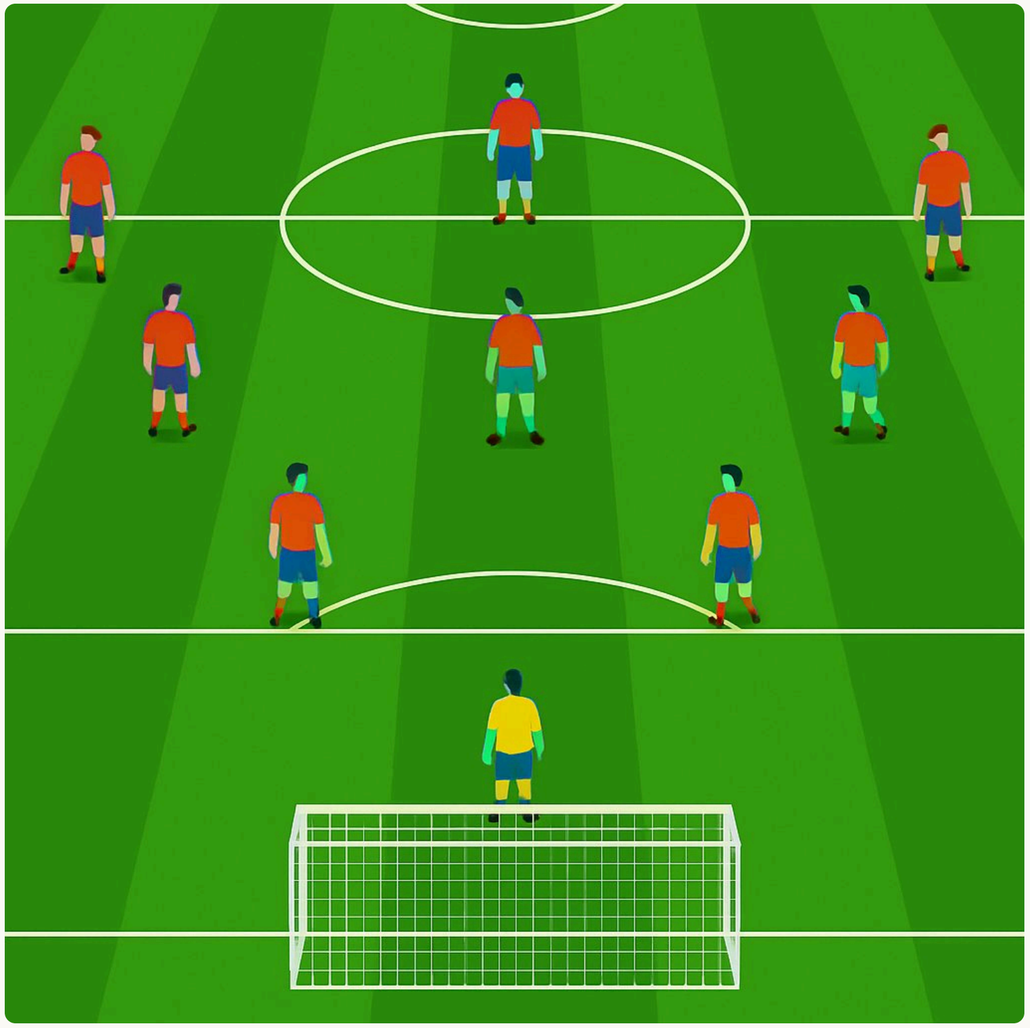



**Discovery:** finding which problems are worth solving and which solutions will reach our goals.

**Delivery:** building the solutions, a slice at a time.

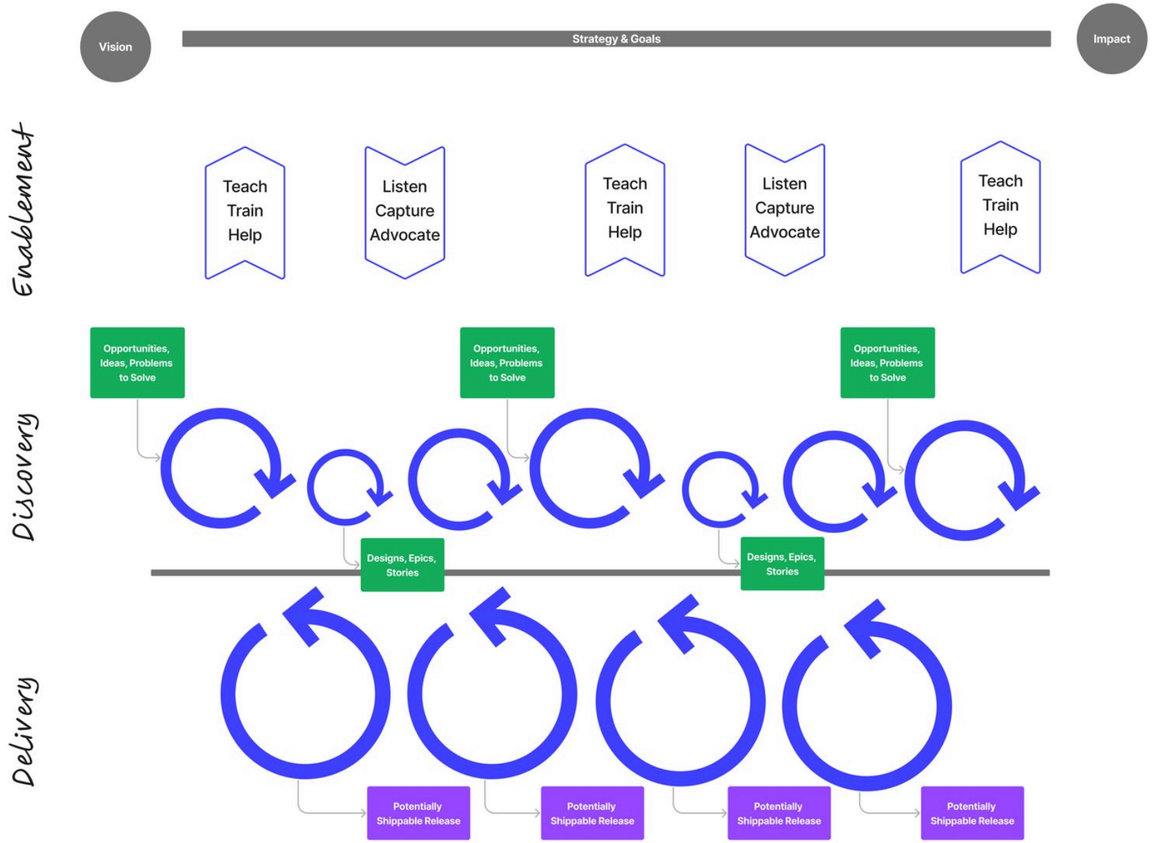
**Enablement:** making sure people succeed with what we release.

These are kinds of work, not separate teams with their own plans.



A soccer team is one team, but it breaks into forwards, midfielders, defenders and a goalie. Each focuses on their own responsibilities while passing the ball to each other. Our team works the same way.

# How the three kinds of work move together



# How we will need to align

| Role | Who | Leads |
|---|---|---|
| **Product manager** | [name] | Owns the roadmap: vision, strategy, goals, plans. Sets the order of Strategic work. |
| **Product owner** | [name] | Works with the delivery team on the backlog. Runs weekly request triage and the small request board. |
| **Scrum master** | [name] | Runs the sprint meetings and the capacity math at planning. |
| **Technical architect** | [name] | Feasibility, technical dependencies, and the order of Technical maintenance and bugs. |
| **UX designer and researcher** | [name] | Discovery research and design readiness. |
| **Content strategist** | [name] | Leads Enable: guides, training, champions, feedback from partners. |
| **Development team** | [names] | Builds, tests and releases; decides how and commits each sprint. |

# Not all work is roadmap work

You have different types of work, and you look to different people for the priorities in each.

### Strategic

Advances a roadmap goal, through discovery or delivery.

**Ordered by the product manager**

### Technical maintenance

Keeps services running, healthy and secure, including bugs.

**Ordered by the technical architect**

### Small requests

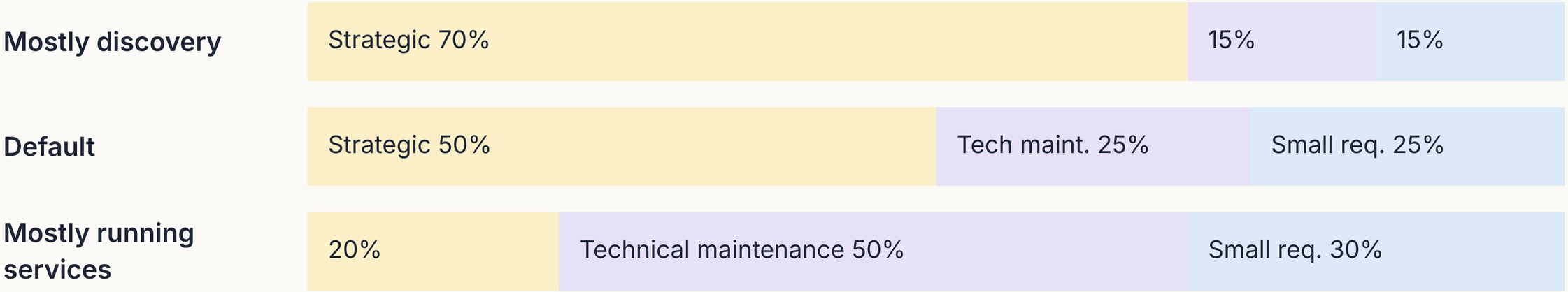
Bounded fixes to what exists, under one sprint.

**Ordered by the product owner**

Organization business (all-hands, mandatory training, timesheets) comes off the top before we count time.

# How we split our time

Default 50/25/25, set each quarter at planning. It varies with your focus area. Examples only.




A guideline, not timesheet tracking. When the split changes, we say why.

# 10 minute break

Review your yellow stickies. Add the ones you're keeping to the wall; we'll go through them during the break.

# Red flags and key yellow questions

# Changes moving forward

What can we start doing differently right away?

### Quarterly planning

Line up the work we intend to finish each quarter, and commit to it together.

### Capacity shares

Know how much time we actually have for each type of work.

### A clear way to prioritize

Balance small requests, technical maintenance and roadmap work, each with its own owner.

# How do planning commitments work?

### EACH QUARTER

The **product manager prioritizes**; the **team commits** to what it believes it can finish in the quarter.

Four half-day sessions: candidates, sizing, technical maintenance and capacity, commitment. Everyone commits out loud.

### EACH SPRINT

**Day 1:** commit to a piece of the strategic work, some small requests and some technical maintenance.

**Days 2 to 10:** do the work, test it, deploy it. Everything should be deployable.

# What happens with a request

Weekly triage: product owner, content strategist, technical architect, product manager. Answer within 5 business days.

| Outcome | What it means | Where it goes |
|---|---|---|
| **Already on the roadmap** | It's already planned | Link to the roadmap item |
| **Small request** | Bounded change to something that exists, under one sprint | Small request board, ordered by the product owner |
| **Large or strategic** | New, bigger than a sprint, or could move a goal | Idea log, for the product manager |
| **Idea for improvement** | Would help people beyond the requester | Idea log, tagged separately |
| **Will not do** | Fails on feasibility, cost or strategy | Closed, with the reason |
| **Future consideration** | Not yes, not no; the requester is told we won't follow up | Stays in the idea log |

Every requester hears back. Bugs skip triage and go to the technical architect.

# Next steps

1. **Quarterly planning in December.** Call it a rehearsal. We'll set our capacity shares as part of planning and make sure the plan fits them.
2. **Then a weekly request review,** so every request gets an answer.
3. **Then sprint commitments** and a sprint report every two weeks.

# Pause for red flags



# Where do we go now?

Where do you need more clarity?

- Specific roles and how they work together
- The whole process with an example
- A deeper look at something we covered
- Examples of anything

*You choose!*

# Key role collaborations




## Product manager and product owner

Work out tradeoffs as estimates and scope change. PM: which problems to solve. PO: how to break the work down.




## Product manager and UX designer and researcher

Make sure we solve valuable problems with useful solutions. PM decides; designer leads the research.



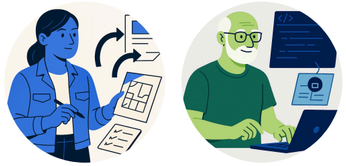
## UX researcher and content strategist

Talk with staff and partners together. Research finds root needs; the content strategist is the everyday touch point.



## UX designer and developers

Settle design details and feasibility together, where changes might be needed.



## Product owner and scrum master

Keep stories ready and sprints healthy. PO leads the content; scrum master leads the process.

## Who to ask

**What and why:** product manager
**How and when:** technical architect or scrum master
**Performance, career, time off:** your functional manager

# Questions people ask

| Question | Honest answer |
|---|---|
| **"We don't have the people."** | Probably true. This doesn't add work; it makes the work visible and limits it. Planning says out loud what doesn't fit. |
| **"So now I have to work 90 hours a week?"** | No. You commit to what you can do without extra hours. If a plan only works with overtime, the plan is wrong. |
| **"What's roadmap work and what isn't?"** | Only Strategic work is on the roadmap. Technical maintenance and small requests each get a protected share. |
| **"Is there a separate roadmap for running things?"** | No. One team, one roadmap. Training and handoffs are Deliverables; running services is Technical maintenance. |
| **"So projects are bad now?"** | No. A hardware refresh is a project and should run as one. Services that keep changing need a different way of working. It's about fit. |
| **"Are we becoming teams within teams?"** | Discovery, delivery and enablement are kinds of work, not separate teams with their own plans. |

# Pause for red flags

Then: start a team agreement, written as situations in the order they happen, and update it whenever someone hits a confusion point.